

in them. You can patch clothing by buying fabric patches and applying with heat-activated adhesive, by sewing a cute patch over a tiny hole, or just stitching it up with a little needle and thread.

15. Reinforce hems

Even cheap clothing can last a long time if you reinforce the hems with a simple stitch on a normal sewing machine. Skirts, pants, even underwear will wear longer and better when the hems are less flimsy. You don't have to be a talented seamstress to hem a pair of pants; anyone can do it with a little practice. In addition, once a shirt's wrists are looking ragged or your slacks are starting to wear at the hem, you can always take them in a bit. Hemlines rise and fall every season, but you can probably safely remove a half-inch from your favorite jeans without anyone noticing. This keeps hems nicer and overall appearance neater. — **Andrea Karim**



10 Ways to Fake It till You Make It

Needing to look the part, even if you'd rather not be bothered? Having to save some scones while still playing the game? I hear you. And sitting on the sidelines isn't always an option—particularly when your network is directly related to your net worth. Here are a few suggestions to help you survive on the corporate playing field and still bank some bucks.

1. Sex up your travel mug

By losing the plastic freebies with the snap-on lids and going for a sleek brushed-steel, insulated model, you'll turn BYO coffee from frumpy to fashionable. Bonus? Your coffee will stay hotter much longer. With \$8–\$15 (much less if you find it on a clearance rack), you've just upped your style factor by several notches.

2. Lose the watch

Anyone who has had to spend time on the heavy hitters' business circuit knows that a great watch is just